



Muncie Redevelopment Commission June 18, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
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Muncie Development Commission (MRC) Meeting Report

Meeting Date: June 18, 2026

Report Type: Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the monthly Muncie Development Commission meeting to order on June 18, 2026, at [00:00:24](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Miller (Presiding Officer), Mr. Previlla, and Ms. Wagley.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Rawlings, and Mr. Lowe.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda for the June 18, 2026 meeting was approved as presented by a voice vote [00:00:59](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting memoranda/minutes were approved as is by a voice vote [00:01:17](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:23 Claims and Financial Obligations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wright
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wright presented the claims, noting several bond payments, facade grant payouts, and a payment for a new downtown Christmas tree at Cannon Commons that came in slightly under budget. Board members expressed excitement regarding the active facade grants and increasing public interest.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:02:40**.
- **00:02:46 Project Updates & Financial Position**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Howe
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Financial Update:* Delayed to the next meeting because Mr. Howe is on contract and lacks current access to city computer systems.
 - *The Point:* Reviewed design/site layouts (50 units consisting of studio, 1-, 2-, and 3-bedroom apartments plus first-floor commercial space). Parking lot installed; new signage drawing visitors following recent storm damage. Commercial tenant contract/LOI is not yet finalized.
 - *Mason Ridge:* Significant ground-moving and site work progress. Home models and direct buyer inquiries are on hold per the developer as it is too early.
 - *Sports Plex:* Moving slowly through the planning phase due to financial feasibility challenges and lack of comparable market sales. Exploring phased hubs (starter and retirement homes).
 - *Wireless Communications Tower:* Delayed due to a DNR requirement redesigning the perimeter (eliminating a fence to prevent debris buildup). Redesign approved by DNR and city engineer; project expected to move forward.
 - *Whitley Property:* Encountering financial feasibility and comparable sale challenges for construction costs. Evaluating rental options, but low area support for rents creates uncertainty. Met with Whitley Community Council.
 - *Plant Tour:* Visited a local manufacturing company planning a ~\$10 million equipment expansion, noting about 50% of its 180-person workforce commutes from Delaware County.
- **00:09:30 Property Transfer: 507 South Proud Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Howe & Mr. Freeman (Attorney)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed a historical count discrepancy regarding the 34-home renovation/30-build project (Old West End Ready project subrecipient agreement with Intend). Mr. Howe requested transferring the property to facilitate project completion. Legal counsel recommended approving the transfer directly to Intend if possible, or through the Land Bank as a facilitator.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Recorded roll-call style: Mr. Miller - Yes, Mr. Pribila - Yes, Ms. Wagley - Yes) [00:13:17](#).
- **00:13:25 Property Transfer: 1904 East Memorial (noted originally as 1912)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Howe & Mr. Freeman
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A property that has remained in the MRC's name for 10 years (sold in 2020 conditioned on repairs, which were completed and inspected as safe, but formal deed transfer stalled over unpaid tax details). Mr. Howe recommended transferring the property directly into the name of the resident/purchaser to remove MRC liability, as the MRC is not a taxing authority. *(Note: Later amended to correct the property address from the MRC mailing address of 1912 to the actual property address of 1904 East Memorial).*
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:15:09](#). Amended to reflect address 1904 East Memorial by voice vote [00:39:52](#).
- **00:15:32 Muncie Downtown Development Partnership (MDDP) Bi-Annual Agreement Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Amanda (Executive Director, MDDP) & Garrett Done (Board President)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Amanda presented MDDP's bi-annual update, highlighting \$5 million in private building improvements in downtown for 2024<U+2013>2025, an annual average net gain of 5<U+2013>7 businesses, and 898,000 annual visits generating \$2.5<U+2013>\$3 million in TIF revenue. Upcoming events include the August 1st *Fire Up Downtown* event (partnering with the Academy of Model Aeronautics). The requested agreement is a standard 2-year renewal (\$40,000 every 6 months), with added language ensuring database availability for MRC/Mr. Howe and a 6-month financial reporting schedule requested by board leadership.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input / Debate:** Ms. Wagley raised concerns about voting on a comprehensive contract packet without sufficient advance review time or prior familiarity with the database metrics.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to table passed by voice vote [00:30:07](#) to allow further review and amendment inclusion.
- **00:30:16 Muncie Land Bank Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Nate Howard clarified land bank property contributions to the Ready project (including successful parcel swaps to save historic homes like 913 West Kilgore and 509 West Adams from demolition). Mentioned future alignment potential regarding Whitley properties and the anticipated PILOT funding assignment tied to the TWG "Allen on Kilgore" housing development. Highlighted upcoming property sales (314 East Myrtle and 2000 block East Russey) for single-family homes endorsed by neighborhoods. Noted a completed 10-month tax sale report showing over half of delinquent properties do not sell annually, suggesting

policy shifts. Currently holding 69 properties primarily for pre-development and blight reduction.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:44:40 Bruce Rector:** President of McKinley Liveler Neighborhood Association. Spoke in opposition to the new Eckerd development on Columbus Avenue, stating it violates the Vanderwall master plan and design guidelines and creates unusable corner space. (*Note: Presiding officer noted this item was outside current MRC jurisdiction*).
 - **00:47:49 Rachel Robertson:** Vice President of McKinley Neighborhood Association. Expressed concern over building permits being issued prior to zoning variance compliance on MRC-transferred land, warning other neighborhoods about opaque public property transfers.
 - **00:50:04 Bill Inman:** McKinley neighborhood resident of 20 years. Requested an immediate pause on construction at the Eckerd development lots, arguing a lack of public review and divergence from expected quality townhomes.
 - **00:52:13 Jonathan Chambers:** Construction professional / developer (Crew Construction). Addressed design standards, architectural vernacular, walkability, and the need for rigorous, consistent design standards in MRC developer agreements.
 - **00:43:32 Bill Lett:** Spoke regarding the McKinley district rezoning process, lot proportions on Columbus Avenue, and concerns over disposition practices for local property lots.
 - **00:57:01 Rebecca Hanna:** Local realtor and downtown resident. Voiced concerns that low-quality, rental-focused developments on Columbus Avenue contradict the city's vision of a vibrant "Mass Ave"-style corridor and undermine investor confidence.
 - **00:59:13 Ricky Antrum:** Author and newsman. Criticized out-of-town developers, housing overbuilding studies, water/aquifer concerns at Mason Ridge, and public records access.
 - **01:01:14 Kylie Tremaine:** South Central Neighborhood Association board member. Stood in solidarity with McKinley residents, emphasizing the importance of neighborhood consent and high standards in public land dispositions.
 - **01:02:47 Chris Smith:** Former chair of McKinley Live Learn Project Management Team. Noted that resident concerns stem from alignment issues regarding density and duplex construction versus long-term single-family character expectations.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Board leadership and staff addressed public comments, clarifying that the MRC's legal function was completed upon entering the Economic Development Agreement

(EDA) and transferring the properties. Oversight of building permits, stop-work orders, and zoning compliance rests with the Building Commissioner and City Engineer, not the MRC.

- Next regular meeting date announced: **July 16th, 2026.**
- **Adjournment:** Officially adjourned at **01:04:26.**

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